

FILM REVIEW

DIL KABADDI

Marital Muddle

Director: Anil Senior

Starring: Irrfan Khan, Konkona Sen Sharma, Soha Ali Khan

Woody Allen is not the easiest filmmaker to rip off, so perhaps the oddly-named Anil Senior is to be praised for attempting to plagiarise the master of urbane laughs. But *Dil Kabaddi* is not exactly *Husbands and Wives*. For one, I can't recall the kind of sexual play seen here, with Irrfan mucking about with G-strings, thongs, inflatable dolls and faux fur. We are to believe he has been tempted away from the cold as ice Soha Ali Khan by the aerobics instructor from Jalandhar whose chief contribution to the film is to stretch her limbs and shriek "sweet

boparra" and "puchku". Rahul Bose and Konkona Sen Sharma as the couple affected by their best friends' separation play their parts well, such as they are, with the former learning to seduce his students and the latter zoning in on the sensitive new age man, Rahul Khanna, who is prone to poetry and tears. There's a lot of talk, not all of it funny, and some particularly icky scenes, with Irrfan going down on his knees, pressing his face into Soha's tummy, and saying "I miss your smell." Funny in parts, tedious in others, this is a sex comedy that is more sex than comedy. And no, that isn't meant as a compliment. **by Kaveree Bamzai**

RATING ★ ★ ☆ ☆ ☆



ART EXHIBITION

Solo Alternative



Her youthful exuberance and a rather detached disregard for tradition is what gives Shrabani Roy and her alternative art its distinction. A solo exhibition, on till December 20 at Akar Prakar gallery in Kolkata, titled Shrabani's Alternative, brings to focus the latest works of this student of Kala Bhavan, Shantiniketan. She uses coloured fibre yarn to form images and patterns, and combines weaving, stitching, knitting and embroidery to create stunning pieces of art, almost like a painter. **by Elora Sen**

ART EXHIBITION

Show Stealer



Eight artists explore the feminine side of creativity with 'Ashtanayika', an all-woman show as they draw references to the eight charismatic heroines, as eulogised by the poet Keshavadasa in his iconic text '*Rasikapriya*'. The performers play with stainless steel as a pigment, adding stunning visuals to their artistic dialogue. At the Stainless Art Gallery, Delhi. On till December 24.